

TheCheeseGrater

The Other Student Magazine of University College London Union



No. 1

LAUNCH ISSUE

March 2004



Israel assassinates Gandalf

Full coverage everywhere but here



Grated Politics

True Blue language

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Few would imagine Conservative Central Office worrying about being infiltrated by nationals of everyone's favourite ex-Soviet Republic, and yet a lucrative employment scheme with some UCL students led to a prohibition on Russians entering the building. While all parties, no doubt, worry about the financial situation of London students, only the Tories

have taken an active role in providing relief. Several students, mainly foreign, were taken on as call centre sweats to poll voters on how they intend to vote at the next election and what might persuade them to go Tory. The pay is relatively generous and the hours variable. Unfortunately, some students were a little over-enthusiastic and became aggressive when people were out or refused to

answer questions. The spate of expletive-filled messages on the answerphones left in broken English on behalf of the Tory party has fortunately not penetrated the mainstream press. However, the poll managers took action and fired the group responsible. All miscreants were Russian and no more Russians have been allowed to man the Tory phones since.

Nick Cowen

Caption Competition



Readers are invited to consider what Jim Dowd MP (Lab, Lewisham West) is saying to this young lady, after the Debating Society Foundation Dinner. (Various possibilities spring to mind, but we do not think it fit to suggest any).

Answers (no more than 30 words, please) to thecheesegrater_magazine@hotmail.com by April 30th.



"This is a fascinating coffee shop. I don't see why they felt the need to stick a bookshop all the way round it."

Didn't like this issue? Think you could do better? Good. So do we.

This issue was cobbled together in a short space of time to prove that we exist and to spark some interest. The next issue will be released in the autumn, and everyone is welcome to contribute to it.

We are looking for talented writers and artists, who can supply the articles, jokes, cartoons, artwork and news stories we so desperately need. This issue was produced by just a couple of people, but next year we will be holding an editorial meeting. We invite you to come along and bring whatever ideas you have, be they sensible or deranged (somewhere in between is usually a good sign).

The Cheese Grater is a UCL Union society, and to contribute, we ask you to join, by taking your ID card to the Clubs and Societies Centre (CSC) on the second floor of the Bloomsbury Building and paying the fee of £3. This goes towards the cost of publicity and photocopying the magazine.

Advertise!

We welcome advertising. Rates have not yet been fixed, but next year, you will be able to contact us to get advertising space.

Tell us a story...

You don't have to write to make this magazine work. We seek to publicise iniquities and scandals that happen in College or the Union. And they do happen – we've heard quite a few, but have been unable to publish some of them for various reasons.

Contact us at the address below

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Grated Politics

First, a little background...

UCL Union's own debating society tries to get in a good number of political bigwigs for its annual dinner debate. While the failure of Margaret Hodge to turn up (she agreed and then excused herself for the second year running) was much noted and joked upon, the absence of another great lady parliamentarian went by unnoticed.

The former society president, James Berry, thought he had done well to get Tory MP Anne Widdecombe in to speak, but did not reckon on the potential cost. Miss Widdecombe agreed, with the proviso that her travel expenses be paid by the Union (first class, of course). In addition, she required that the debate be used as a stage to sell her new book.

Not that she put it like that: her emissary said that the society 'had an opportunity to make some money': for each book sold they were prepared to donate 35% of the proceeds. So Miss Widdecombe sees fit to bribe people to boost her flagging media profile/book sales.

Unfortunately, since Parliament sits on a Wednesday, she could not guarantee being able to attend at all. But she still expected to be paid in advance, for the mere possibility of her attendance; or perhaps she planned to send one of her delightful and highly publicised cats (Pugwash II or Arbuthnot) as proxy voters? It should be noted that other luminaries such as Boris Johnson promised to attend with no such demands; no, not even a stall to sell the Spectator from.

Nick Cowen



Ann Widdecombe MP, star of Celebrity Fit Club and When Louis Met..., has suffered at the cruel hands of UCL Union Debating Society. Now it is time to give her the publicity she deserves...

Don't miss the chance to see...

Ann Widdecombe LIV

To boost the popularity of Ann's one-woman show, *An Evening with Ann Widdecombe*, we have kindly moved the events to more popular venues where Ann is sure of a warm welcome. Come one, come all!

**19th May 2004 – UCL Halls Dope Smoking Festival
for Evans Hall, 109 Camden Road, London NW1**

Clasping a silken handkerchief to her nose to avoid getting mashed, Ann will address a public meeting and warn the assembled cannabis users that they face 10-year minimum prison terms under a Tory government, before being undermined by her fellow party members, succumbing to the fumes and diving into the canal, whence she will swim back to Maidstone.

**24th June 2004 – G-A-Y at the Astoria
London Astoria, 157 Charing Cross Road, London WC2**

Ann will act as a supporting act for Christina Aguilera and tell the assembled crowd that they are all going straight to Hell.

**26th June 2004 – Live Tory Aid at Wembley Arena
Wembley Arena, Lakeside Way, Wembley**

Ann will MC and read poetry at an event to boost Tory party funds. Bob Geldof has promised to attend (although he warns that Parliamentary proceedings may call him away on the actual day.)



**Ann
Widdecombe
for the Nobel
Prize for
Literature!**

Not only is there that stunner of a book, but just read these uplifting lines, penned, no doubt, in a transcendental moment of domestic bliss:

*"Goodness gracious, what is that?
Mr Pugwash, my black cat;
Goodness gracious, are there
others?
Yes indeed, my cat Carruthers!"*

(Both now believed dead – Ed.)
I ask you! Did Byron succeed in capturing the kaleidoscope of life so perfectly? Did the Rossettis? Or Ted Hughes? No, they bloody didn't! Thank God for Ann, or there'd be nothing in British Literature worth reading!



The Gorgon Zola

Lady Gorgon Zola, alumnus of UCL, actress, writer, amateur philosopher, wit, raconteuse and self-professed excellent cook takes the time to put her musings into words for the greater good of mankind.....

I woke today to discover the most momentous news item I'd heard in a very long time. Man on his way to shake man's hand in tent. And then, sure enough, later on in the day, yes, man shakes man's hand in tent. So, the 'man 1' was Tony Blair and 'man 2' was actually pariah/statesman in transition Colonel Gaddafi who of course was a very very bad man but apparently now is considering being a good man and for this change of heart what does he get? To touch the hand of God! Or that's what you'd infer from the way they keep going on about it. I'm sure Tony Blair would be very pleased to hear the importance given to the touching of this transitional 'unclean/clean' man. Maybe the truth is that Tony Blair is in fact Jesus Christ on his second coming and in touching Gaddafi's hand he has been able to purify and atone him of his insidious leprotic personality. Lets hope so. I've been waiting for the second coming for a few years now as I was promised it would bring lots of fireworks and parties!

Talking of parties, I'm sure you will agree that no party is complete without plenty of champagne. What I hear you call? 'I can't afford champagne you lunatic, I'm a student.' Well, you bloody well can and the sooner you'll start to enjoy life, the merriment induced is sine qua non. In fact it has been proven that persistent indulgence in this fine nectar results in a notable wellness of being. Note indulgence and not over-indulgence as this is wasteful and wanton and will be punished by God – see above. Rather a couple of bottles per week should suffice and you will notice the benefits immediately. Never has it been so easy or cheap. In my day there were only a few champagnes on the market and I would have to trail down to Sainsbury on Camden Rd and spend 27 pounds on a bottle of bolly. These days deregulation of the market = greater competition and depressed prices = happy me - hurray! For all you economists out there this is the true upside to free market economics. I can recommend for all you who

are still salivating over the prospect of consuming a bottle of Sanatogen British Fortified wine ce soir on the basis that its cheap and it'll get you pissed, go ahead and preserve yourselves in it. For those with taste, learn that with a tight budget in mind I can let you into a little secret. French *appellation contrôlée* means that only those wines produced in the champagne region can be so called. Few people know that the Loire and Burgundy – Bourgogne produce the same wines with the same grapes in the same way but as they are outside champagne they command lower prices. For maximum pleasure at minimum expense I recommend one of these notably Oddbins Cremant de Bourgogne at 7.49!!!!!! Go and buy it now: no one will understand the label enough to realise you haven't bought the real thing making you look both generous and classy.

S DONLON Stundet

~~UCL's~~ London's best proof-read student paper

STATE OF THE UNION

UCL Union has moved to ban all students from its organisation. A special report by Guest Political Correspondent GERRY THE GERBIL.

There were faint ripples of mild surprise on Monday when a UCL Union general meeting moved to "disaffiliate all students from the union." The proposed amendment was put forward as an emergency motion just after the union elections. The grounds for the motion, officially, was that students are divisive in nature, prohibitive to the efficient running of the union, unhygienic and do not deserve any of the Union's money. This comes in the midst of a pressing need to increase interest in union politics. It is thought that the extreme motion may have been a thinly veiled attempt to encourage someone, anyone to turn up to the meeting.

General Secretary Stephen Fingleton, who wrote an article for *Barely Legal* magazine supporting the motion, and then voted against it, admitted "the important thing is that an audience turns up to vote; I am not too bothered which way it goes but the original union constitution was clearly anti-student affiliation." It worked,



as the meeting noted a stratospheric 0.02% rise in voter turnout. Others present, however, seemed to be taking the motion more seriously. "I hope it does get passed," said one attendee, "it would mean the Union can finally get on with what it was founded for: arguing with university management and supporting pointless strikes to look more credibly left-wing."

Nick Cowen

Hateful union politics must stop

By Mariyella Whingebag

I think it is absolutely appalling and horrible that people are putting forward motions like this one. Look at all the different opinions people are expressing. If we carry on putting up motions, and then other people disagree with the motions, everyone will end up hating each other and there'll be a big war and then everyone will die and then there won't be anyone left to be in student politics, I mean it's too horrible to punctuate. We should never allow ourselves to risk disagreeing with each other in student politics. Instead we should all be drugged against rational thought (*cont'd. pp. 2-96*)



That General Meeting saw a hapless student challenge the authority of the Chair, one Stephen Fingleton. And His wrath is terrible...

Transcript

Scene: In front of the Praetorium of the General Secretary of the Judaeen People's Union, Pontius Pilate. An **Ugly Jewish Mob** has assembled, baying for blood. Near the front stands the **Jewish High Priest**, hot blood staining his face red, a college ID card blazing red through his breast pocket. **Rick Jones** appears before the crowd.

Jones (R. Jones): I would like to call a motion of no confidence in the ch...

Jewish High Priest (S. Fingleton): Crucify him! Crucify him!

The Ugly Jewish Mob is

whipped up by his devastating rhetoric.

Ugly Jewish Mob: Crucify him! Crucify him!

Pontius Pilate (S. Fingleton): I call for a half-hour speech on why this man Jones should be crucified. (**Jewish High Priest** raises his hand.) Yes, sir.

Jewish High Priest: Mr. General Secretary, this man is a tool of Margaret Thatcher, a vile poisonous Tory scumbag, an enemy of student democracy. He has committed blasphemy against My holy Name, by calling me a twat at the last general meeting. (*Cries of 'Stone him! Stone him!'*) He should therefore be crucified, to show that is not fit to stand

on this earth.

(At this, the **Ugly Jewish Mob** seize hold of **Rick Jones**, whip him, put a crown of thorns on his head, spit on him, jeer at him, nail him to a cross and watch him die in agony.

Andreas von Maltzahn looks on in wonderment, almost too surprised to operate the shutter of his digital camera.)

von Maltzahn: At last, a story for Pi magazine that people will want to read! But is there nothing against this in Standing Orders?

General Secretary (S. Fingleton): No.